Alternative plan · earlier version

Diwali Trip to Punjab & Himachal Pradesh

8 – 17 November 2026

Ahmedabad → Amritsar → Dalhousie → Dharamshala → Kangra → Kullu → Lahaul → Mandi → Chandigarh

Plan as of: 22 October 2026

Earlier plan — kept for reference

- This is the original plan from the trip document. The final plan is on the main page.
- It includes Chamera Lake, Kangra Fort and a night in Kangra.
- Only one night in Lahaul — no full day at Jispa.

WHERE WE SLEEP

Sun, 8 Nov	On the train	On the train
Mon, 9 Nov	Amritsar	Booking pending
Tue, 10 Nov	Dalhousie Hotel Himdhara Dalhousie	Confirmed
Wed, 11 Nov	Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj Hotel Pine View	Confirmed
Thu, 12 Nov	Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj Hotel Pine View	Confirmed
Fri, 13 Nov	Kangra	Booking pending
Sat, 14 Nov	Kullu	Booking pending
Sun, 15 Nov	Keylong / Lahaul Valley View Homestay Fuktal, Lahaul	Confirmed
Mon, 16 Nov	Mandi	Booking pending
Tue, 17 Nov	On the train (arrive GNC Wed 18 Nov, 03:05 PM)	On the train

TRAINS

19107 Janmabhoomi Express	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) Sun 8 Nov · 10:05 AM	Jalandhar City Mon 9 Nov · 10:00 AM	3A · B1 37, 38, 40
19412 DLPC GNC Express	Chandigarh (CDG) Tue 17 Nov · 05:55 PM	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) Wed 18 Nov · 03:05 PM	3A · B2 27, 29, 30

Booking numbers are partly hidden; check your email or SMS for the full numbers.

Day 1

Sunday, 8 November

The Departure

Ahmedabad → on the train

● **Relaxed** · Train day — rest on board

Wake up: As per your comfort

09:00 AM	Board Janmabhoomi Express from Ahmedabad (boarding station: Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) at 10:05 AM).

19107 · Janmabhoomi Express — Confirmed

Departs	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) — Sun 8 Nov · 10:05 AM
Arrives	Jalandhar City — Mon 9 Nov · 10:00 AM
Class · Coach · Berths	3A · B1 · 37, 38, 40
PNR	••••••0791

Night stay: On the train

Day 2

Monday, 9 November

The Golden Hour

Jalandhar → Amritsar

● **Moderate** · Arrive after the night train; Wagah and Golden Temple

Wake up: 07:30 AM (on the train, to get ready for arrival)

10:00 AM	Arrive at Jalandhar City Railway Station. Hire your Tempo Traveller.
10:30 AM – 12:30 PM	Drive from Jalandhar to Amritsar.
12:30 PM	Hotel check-in near the Golden Temple and lunch.
02:00 PM	Depart for the Wagah Border.
04:15 – 05:00 PM	Attari-Wagah Border Ceremony. **Tip:** Winter timings usually start at 4:15 PM, but arrive early to get seats.
07:30 PM	Sri Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple) at night, then dinner outside.

Hotel near the Golden Temple — Booking pending

Night stay: Amritsar

Day 3

Tuesday, 10 November

Ascent to Dalhousie & The Peak

Amritsar → Dalhousie

● **Tough** · 5:30 AM start, ~5.5 h drive, then the Dainkund trek

Wake up: 05:30 AM (early start for a long drive and a daylight trek)

07:00 AM	Depart Amritsar.
12:30 PM	Arrive in Dalhousie, check into your hotel, and grab a quick lunch. **Tip:** Hotel check-in is from 2 PM — leave the luggage at reception and check in after the trek.
01:30 PM	Drive to the Dainkund Peak base.
02:00 – 05:00 PM	Dainkund Peak Trek (2 km trek). **Tip:** Start by 2 PM so you are off the trail before the sun sets around 5:30 PM.
06:00 PM	Evening stroll at the Town Center, Mall Road, and colonial viewpoints.

Hotel Himdhara Dalhousie

Confirmed

Address	Church Baloon Road, near Gandhi Chowk, Dalhousie – 176304
Check-in	Tue 10 Nov, after 02:00 PM
Check-out	Wed 11 Nov, before 12:00 PM
Booked via	MakeMyTrip · Booking ID NH••••••••0644

Night stay: Dalhousie

Day 4

Wednesday, 11 November

The Lake & The Valley

Dalhousie → Chamera Lake → Dharamshala

● **Busy** · Chamera Lake, then ~5 h on the road

Wake up: 07:00 AM

08:30 AM	Drive to Chamera Lake (approx. 1.5 hours).
10:00 – 11:30 AM	Explore Chamera Lake (boating available).
11:30 AM – 04:00 PM	Drive from Chamera Lake to Dharamshala.
04:00 PM	Arrive in Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj and check in.
05:30 PM	Evening exploring McLeod Ganj Mall Road.

Hotel Pine View

Confirmed

2 nights (Nov 11 – 13) · Night 1

Address	VPO Sudher, Dharamshala – 176215
Check-in	Wed 11 Nov, after 12:00 PM
Check-out	Fri 13 Nov, before 12:00 PM
Booked via	MakeMyTrip · Booking ID NH••••••••9134

Night stay: Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj

Day 5

Thursday, 12 November

Tibetan Heritage & Waterfalls

McLeod Ganj

● **Moderate** · Walking day, no long drive

Wake up: 06:00 AM

07:00 AM	Leave the hotel to enjoy the crisp mountain air. **Tip:** McLeod Ganj lanes are too narrow for the Tempo Traveller — walk or use local taxis around McLeod, Bhagsu and Naddi today.
07:30 AM	Breakfast at a local bakery near the Main Square.
08:45 AM	Dalai Lama Temple & Museum (catch the morning chants).
11:00 AM	Bhagsunag Temple and the hike to Bhagsu Waterfall.
01:15 PM	Lunch at a hillside cafe with a view.
03:15 PM	St. John in the Wilderness Church.
04:30 PM	Naddi View Point. **Tip:** Arrive before the 5:30 PM sunset.
06:30 PM	Free time in Main Square for shopping and exploring.
07:30 PM	Dinner (authentic Tibetan food).

Hotel Pine View Confirmed

Night 2 of 2

Night stay: Dharamshala / McLeod Ganj

Day 6

Friday, 13 November

Forts & Blessings

Dharamshala → Kangra

● **Busy** · Many stops from Dharamshala to Kangra

Wake up: 06:00 AM

07:00 AM	Leave the hotel and drive down into the lower Dharamshala valley.
07:45 AM	Breakfast in Kotwali Bazaar.
09:00 AM	HPCA Stadium.
10:30 AM	Kunal Pathri Temple in the tea gardens.
11:45 AM – 01:30 PM	Norbulingka Institute. **Tip:** Closed on Sundays, but today is Friday, so it is open.
01:30 PM	Lunch at Norbulingka's garden cafe.
02:30 – 03:30 PM	Drive to Kangra Fort.
03:30 – 05:00 PM	Explore Kangra Fort. **Tip:** Closes at 5:30 PM.
05:00 – 06:00 PM	Drive to Mata Baglamukhi Temple.
06:00 – 07:00 PM	Darshan at Mata Baglamukhi. **Tip:** Open until 11:30 PM.

Hotel in Kangra — Booking pending

Night stay: Kangra

Day 7

Saturday, 14 November

The Spiritual Circuit & Paragliding Hub

Kangra → Baijnath → Bir → Kullu

● **Tough** · Kangra → Baijnath → Bir → Kullu, ~8 h on the road

Wake up: 06:00 AM (early start for heavy driving)

07:30 AM	Drive from Kangra to Baijnath.
09:30 AM	Shree Shiv Baijnath Temple.
10:30 AM	Tashi Jong Khampagar Monastery.
11:30 AM	Sherabling Monastery.
01:00 PM	Lunch in Bir and a quick look at the Bir Billing paragliding landing site.
02:30 – 06:30 PM	Drive from Bir to Kullu (approx. 4 hours via Mandi).

Hotel in Kullu — Booking pending

Night stay: Kullu

Day 8

Sunday, 15 November

Through the Tunnel to Lahaul

Kullu → Atal Tunnel → Sissu → Keylong

● **Moderate** · Tunnel, Sissu and Keylong

Wake up: 07:00 AM

08:30 – 11:30 AM	Drive from Kullu to Sissu via the Atal Tunnel.
11:30 AM – 02:00 PM	Explore Sissu, the waterfall viewpoint, and the Chandra River banks.
02:00 – 03:30 PM	Drive further north into the Lahaul Valley to Keylong (approx. 30 km).
03:30 – 05:00 PM	Check into your hotel and enjoy the uninterrupted views of the glaciated Kardang peaks.

Valley View Homestay Fuktal, Lahaul — Confirmed

Address	Village Fuktal, Gondla, Lahaul – 175140
Check-in	Sun 15 Nov, 12:00 – 02:00 PM
Check-out	Mon 16 Nov, before 10:00 AM
Booked via	Goibibo · Booking ID GH••••••••0370

Night stay: Keylong / Lahaul

Day 9

Monday, 16 November

The Lahaul Morning & Descent to Mandi

Keylong → Atal Tunnel → Mandi

● **Busy** · ~6.5 h drive down to Mandi

Wake up: 06:30 AM

07:30 – 09:00 AM	Enjoy a crisp, snowy morning in Keylong.
09:00 AM – 03:30 PM	Scenic drive from Keylong back through the Atal Tunnel, bypassing Manali, straight down the river valley to Mandi (approx. 6.5 hours of driving). **Tip:** Leave early to account for mountain traffic.
03:30 PM	Late lunch on arrival in Mandi (or stop along the route).
05:00 PM	Check into your hotel and relax by the Beas River.

Hotel in Mandi, by the Beas River — Booking pending

Night stay: Mandi

Day 10

Tuesday, 17 November

The Journey Home

Mandi → Chandigarh → home

● **Moderate** · ~5 h drive before the evening train

Wake up: 06:30 AM

07:30 AM – 12:30 PM	Drive from Mandi to Chandigarh (approx. 5 hours). **Tip:** Leave early to account for mountain traffic.
12:30 – 03:00 PM	Lunch in Chandigarh. If time permits, a quick walk around Sukhna Lake.
04:00 PM	Arrive at Chandigarh Railway Station.
05:55 PM	Board the train to Gandhinagar from Chandigarh (CDG).

19412 · DLPC GNC Express — Confirmed

Departs	Chandigarh (CDG) — Tue 17 Nov · 05:55 PM
Arrives	Gandhinagar Capital (GNC) — Wed 18 Nov · 03:05 PM
Class · Coach · Berths	3A · B2 · 27, 29, 30
PNR	••••••7012

Night stay: On the train (arrive GNC Wed 18 Nov, 03:05 PM)